

ENGAGE

1. Passage anchor

> “...especially novels that tell an **engaging** story while also leaving you with something deeper to think about.”

Passage meaning

engaging = interesting, attractive, or enjoyable enough to hold someone's attention

引人入勝的；吸引人的；有吸引力的

Here, the speaker means a story that keeps the reader interested and emotionally involved.

Practice

1. The novel has an **engaging** story from beginning to end.

這本小說從頭到尾都有一個**引人入勝的**故事。

2. She is an **engaging** speaker who keeps the audience interested.

她是一位很**吸引人的**講者，能一直抓住觀眾的注意力。

Core meanings of ENGAGE

2. engage — attract and hold attention

= interest someone and keep their attention

吸引；引起興趣；使投入

Examples

1. A good opening should **engage** the reader immediately.

好的開頭應該立刻**吸引讀者**。

2. The lesson **engaged** the students.

這堂課**引起了學生的興趣**。

This is the core branch behind the passage adjective **engaging**.

3. engage someone's attention / interest

= attract and hold someone's attention or curiosity

****吸引某人的注意力 / 興趣****

Examples

1. The puzzle quickly ****engaged his attention****.
這個謎題很快就****吸引了他的注意力****。
2. The topic failed to ****engage their interest****.
這個主題未能****引起他們的興趣****。

Participate / become involved

4. engage in something

= take part in an activity

****參與；從事****

Examples

1. Students were encouraged to ****engage in discussion****.
學生被鼓勵****參與討論****。
2. The company ****engages in international trade****.
這家公司****從事國際貿易****。

Very high-value construction.

5. engage with something

= become actively involved with an idea, issue, text, problem, etc.

****積極接觸；投入；深入思考****

Examples

1. Readers are encouraged to ****engage with the ideas**** in the book.
讀者被鼓勵****深入思考並回應書中的觀點****。
2. The course asks students to ****engage with difficult questions****.
這門課要求學生****積極思考艱難問題****。

Interact / communicate

6. engage with someone

= interact, communicate, or build a connection with someone

與某人互動；交流；接觸

Examples

1. Teachers need to **engage with students**.
老師需要和學生**互動**。
2. The organization tries to **engage with local communities**.
該組織努力與當地社區**交流合作**。

7. engage someone in conversation

= start or involve someone in conversation

與某人攀談；使某人加入談話

Examples

1. She **engaged him in conversation**.
她主動和他**攀談起來**。
2. The host tried to **engage everyone in discussion**.
主持人試圖讓每個人都**參與討論**。

Employ / hire services

8. engage someone

Formal:

= hire or employ someone, especially for professional services

聘用；僱用

Examples

1. They **engaged a lawyer** to review the contract.
他們**聘請了一位律師**審查合約。

2. The company **engaged a consultant**.

公司**聘用了顧問**。

Distinct formal sense.

9. engage the services of someone

= formally hire someone's professional services

聘用某人的服務

Examples

1. They **engaged the services of an architect**.

他們**聘用了建築師的服務**。

2. The family **engaged the services of a specialist**.

那個家庭**聘請了一位專家**。

Occupy / keep busy

10. engage someone

= occupy someone's attention, time, or activity

使忙於；使投入

Examples

1. The activity **engaged the children for hours**.

這個活動讓孩子們**投入了好幾個小時**。

2. She remained **engaged in her work** all afternoon.

她整個下午都**專注於工作**。

Mechanical connection

11. engage — gears/parts connect

= fit together so that mechanical parts begin working together

嚙合；接合

Examples

1. The gears failed to ****engage****.
齒輪未能正常****嚙合****。
2. Press the lever to ****engage the mechanism****.
按下控制桿讓機械裝置****接合****。

Major technical sense.

12. engage the clutch / gear

= connect a mechanism so power is transmitted
****接合離合器 / 掛入齒輪****

Examples

1. Slowly ****engage the clutch****.
慢慢****接合離合器****。
2. The driver ****engaged first gear****.
駕駛者****掛入一檔****。

Combat / confrontation

13. engage the enemy

= enter into combat with an opponent
****與敵人交戰****

Examples

1. The troops ****engaged the enemy**** near the bridge.
部隊在橋附近****與敵軍交戰****。
2. The aircraft was ordered to ****engage the target****.
飛機奉命****攻擊目標****。

Distinct military sense.

14. engage in combat / battle

= take part in fighting

****參戰；交戰****

Examples

1. The forces ****engaged in battle****.
雙方軍隊****投入戰鬥****。
2. The unit was not authorized to ****engage in combat****.
該部隊未獲授權****參戰****。

Formal commitment / agreement

15. engage to do something

Formal/older:

= commit or promise to do something

****承諾；答應****

Examples

1. He ****engaged to complete**** the work by Friday.
他****承諾****星期五前完成工作。
2. The firm ****engaged to provide**** support.
公司****承諾提供****支援。

Less common in everyday modern English.

Relationship / marriage

16. engaged — formally promised to marry

= having agreed to marry someone

****已訂婚的****

Examples

1. They are ****engaged****.

他們**訂婚了**。

2. She got **engaged** last month.

她上個月**訂婚了**。

Major family meaning.

17. engaged to someone

= formally promised in marriage to someone

與某人訂婚

Examples

1. He is **engaged to** Maya.

他和 Maya **訂婚了**。

2. She became **engaged to** her longtime partner.

她和交往多年的伴侶**訂婚了**。

18. engagement — marriage agreement

= formal agreement to marry

訂婚；婚約

Examples

1. They announced their **engagement**.

他們宣布了**訂婚消息**。

2. Her **engagement ring** is simple and elegant.

她的**訂婚戒指**簡潔又優雅。

Appointment / commitment

19. engagement — appointment or arrangement

= planned meeting, appointment, performance, or commitment

約會；約定；活動安排

Examples

1. I have a previous **engagement** this evening.
我今晚已有其他**約定**。
2. The speaker has several public **engagements** this week.
這位講者本週有幾場公開**活動安排**。

Involvement / participation

20. engagement — involvement

= degree of attention, participation, or emotional involvement

****參與度；投入度****

Examples

1. Student **engagement** improved.
學生的**參與度**提高了。
2. The campaign increased audience **engagement**.
這場活動提升了觀眾**互動參與度**。

Very common modern business/education/media sense.

21. employee engagement

= degree to which employees feel committed, motivated, and involved in their work

****員工投入度；員工敬業度****

Examples

1. The survey measures **employee engagement**.
這項調查衡量**員工投入度**。
2. Flexible work can affect **employee engagement**.
彈性工作可能影響**員工投入度**。

22. audience / customer engagement

= interaction, involvement, or attention from an audience/customer base

****觀眾 / 顧客參與度 ; 互動程度****

Examples

1. The video generated strong audience ****engagement****.

這段影片帶來很高的觀眾****互動度****。

2. The company wants to improve customer ****engagement****.

公司希望提升顧客****參與與互動****。

Engaging adjective

23. engaging — interesting/charming

= pleasant, interesting, and able to attract attention

****吸引人的 ; 引人入勝的 ; 迷人的****

This is the exact passage form.

Examples

1. She has an ****engaging personality****.

她的個性很****討人喜歡 / 吸引人****。

2. The book has an ****engaging style****.

這本書的風格很****引人入勝****。

Engaged adjective

24. engaged — busy / occupied

= involved in or busy with an activity

****忙於 ; 投入於****

Examples

1. She was deeply ****engaged in conversation****.

她正****全神貫注地交談****。

2. He remained ****engaged in research****.

他一直****投入研究工作****。

25. engaged — telephone line busy

Especially traditional BrE:

= telephone line already in use

****佔線的****

Examples

1. The line is ****engaged****.

電話****佔線中****。

2. I called twice, but the number was ****engaged****.

我打了兩次，但電話都****佔線****。

Still recognized, though less prominent in mobile-phone usage.

Engagement with ideas/issues

26. critical engagement

= active, thoughtful examination of ideas rather than passive acceptance

****批判性投入；深入思考與回應****

Examples

1. The essay shows strong ****critical engagement**** with the text.

這篇文章展現了對文本充分的****批判性思考與回應****。

2. The course encourages ****critical engagement**** with different viewpoints.

這門課鼓勵對不同觀點進行****深入批判思考****。

High-value expressions

27. engage someone's imagination

= stimulate someone to imagine actively

****激發某人的想像力****

Examples

1. The story ****engages the reader's imagination****.
故事****激發讀者的想像力****。
2. Good fantasy should ****engage the imagination****.
好的奇幻作品應該能****引發想像****。

28. engage directly with

= interact with or seriously address something without avoiding it
****直接面對 / 直接與.....互動****

Examples

1. The book ****engages directly with**** questions of regret.
這本書****直接探討****後悔這個議題。
2. Leaders need to ****engage directly with**** employees.
領導者需要****直接與員工交流****。

29. actively engaged

= strongly involved and participating
****積極參與的；高度投入的****

Examples

1. The students were ****actively engaged**** in the lesson.
學生都****積極投入****課堂。
2. She remains ****actively engaged**** in community work.
她一直****積極參與****社區工作。

Key contrasts

30. engage vs interest

****interest****

= make someone curious or attentive

****使感興趣****

****engage****

= attract attention and often keep the person actively involved

****吸引並使投入****

Compare:

> The topic interests me.

> 這個主題讓我感興趣。

> The story engages me.

> 這個故事讓我一直投入其中。

31. engaging vs interesting

****interesting****

= worthy of attention

****有趣的****

****engaging****

= actively holds attention and often has a pleasant/charming quality

****引人入勝的；吸引人的****

An engaging story is usually interesting, but ****engaging**** emphasizes sustained involvement.

32. engage in vs engage with

****engage in****

= participate in an activity

****參與 / 從事某活動****

> engage in discussion

> 參與討論

****engage with****

= interact with or thoughtfully address a person, idea, issue, text, etc.

****與.....互動 / 深入處理****

> engage with an argument

> 深入思考一個論點

This distinction is very useful.

33. engage vs involve

****involve****

= include someone/something as part of an activity or situation

****涉及；使參與****

****engage****

= often emphasizes active participation, attention, or interaction

****投入；參與；互動****

34. engaged vs busy

****busy****

= having many things to do

****忙的****

****engaged****

= occupied with a particular activity, often more formal

****正忙於 / 投入於****

35. engaged vs married

****engaged****

= formally promised to marry

****已訂婚****

****married****

= legally/socially joined in marriage

****已婚****

Meaning map

The central concept of ****engage**** is:

****connect with something so that attention, participation, contact, or action begins****

From this develop:

Passage

engaging story

→ **引人入勝的故事**

Attention

engage the reader

→ **吸引讀者**

Activity

engage in discussion

→ **參與討論**

Ideas

engage with a text

→ **深入思考文本**

People

engage with customers

→ **與顧客互動**

Conversation

engage someone in conversation

→ **與某人攀談**

Employment

engage a lawyer

→ **聘請律師**

Machinery

gears engage

→ **齒輪嚙合**

Combat

engage the enemy

→ **與敵軍交戰**

Marriage

be engaged

→ **訂婚**

Participation noun

engagement

→ **參與度 / 投入度**

The passage uses the **attention-holding** adjective branch:

> an **engaging story**

> → **一個能吸引讀者、讓人投入其中的故事**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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engage — attract attention	吸引並持續抓住某人的注意力 / 興趣
engage someone's attention/interest	引起並維持某人的注意 / 興趣
engage in something	積極參與或從事某項活動
engage with something	積極接觸、深入思考或回應某議題 / 文本
engage with someone	與某人互動、交流或建立接觸
engage someone in conversation	主動讓某人加入談話 / 與某人攀談
engage someone — hire	正式聘請某人提供專業服務
engage someone — occupy	使某人忙於 / 投入某項活動
engage — machinery	機械零件互相接合、嚙合並開始運作
engage the clutch/gear	接合離合器 / 掛入齒輪
engage the enemy/target	與敵人交戰 / 對目標採取攻擊行動
engage in combat	參與戰鬥；交戰
engage to do — formal	正式承諾做某事
engaged — marriage	已正式答應結婚的；訂婚的
engaged to someone	與某人訂婚
engagement — marriage	訂婚；婚約
engagement — appointment	已安排好的約會、活動或工作安排
engagement — involvement	對活動、內容等的參與度 / 投入程度
employee engagement	員工對工作的投入、認同與參與程度
audience/customer engagement	觀眾 / 顧客的互動與參與程度
engaging — attractive/interesting	能持續吸引注意的；引人入勝 / 吸引人的
engaged — occupied	正忙於並投入某活動的
engaged — telephone	電話線正在使用中；佔線的
engage the imagination	激發並吸引某人的想像力

| **actively engaged**

| 正積極參與 / 高度投入的

|

Passage recap

> "...novels that tell an **engaging story** while also leaving you with something deeper to think about."

Here:

engaging = **interesting and appealing enough to keep the reader's attention**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **引人入勝的**

* **吸引人的**

* **能讓人投入其中的**

Natural contextual translation:

尤其是那些既有引人入勝的故事，又能讓人留下更深思考的小說。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

engaging

= **pleasant or interesting in a way that attracts and holds attention**

引人入勝的；吸引人的；令人投入的

The most useful contrast is:

> **interesting**

> → 讓人覺得有趣、值得注意

while:

> **engaging**

> → **不只引起興趣，還能把人的注意力持續抓住**

And the base verb expands considerably:

> **engage the reader**

> → 吸引讀者

> **engage in discussion**

> → 參與討論

> **engage with an idea**

> → 深入思考 / 回應觀點

> **engage a lawyer**

> → 聘請律師

> gears **engage**

> → 齒輪嚙合

> become **engaged**

> → 訂婚

In the passage, it is specifically the **attention-holding / appealing** branch.